

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 16

Nehemiah

Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 16

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Nehemiah

Nehemiah 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 The memoirs of Nehemiah son of Hacaliah. It was the month of Kislev in the twentieth year. At the time I was in the palace complex at Susa.
- 1 The words of Nehemiah son of Hacaliah: In the month of Kislev in the twentieth year, while I was in the citadel of Susa,
 - 2 Hanani, one of my brothers, had just arrived from Judah with some fellow Jews. I asked them about the conditions among the Jews there who had survived the exile, and about Jerusalem.
 - 2 Hanani, one of my brothers, came from Judah with some other men, and I questioned them about the Jewish remnant that survived the exile, and also about Jerusalem.
 - 3 They told me, "The exile survivors who are left there in the province are in bad shape. Conditions are appalling. The wall of Jerusalem is still rubble; the city gates are still cinders."
 - 3 They said to me, "Those who survived the exile and are back in the province are in great trouble and disgrace. The wall of Jerusalem is broken down, and its gates have been burned with fire."
 - 4 When I heard this, I sat down and wept. I mourned for days, fasting and praying before the God-of-Heaven.
 - 4 When I heard these things, I sat down and wept. For some days I mourned and fasted and prayed before the God of heaven.
 - 5 I said, "GOD, God-of-Heaven, the great and awesome God, loyal to his covenant and faithful to those who love him and obey his commands:
 - 5 Then I said: "O LORD, God of heaven, the great and awesome God, who keeps his covenant of love with those who love him and obey his commands,
 - 6 Look at me, listen to me. Pay attention to this prayer of your servant that I'm praying day and night in intercession for your servants, the People of

- Israel, confessing the sins of the People of Israel. And I'm including myself, I and my ancestors, among those who have sinned against you.
- 6 let your ear be attentive and your eyes open to hear the prayer your servant is praying before you day and night for your servants, the people of Israel. I confess the sins we Israelites, including myself and my father's house, have committed against you.
- 7 "We've treated you like dirt: We haven't done what you told us, haven't followed your commands, and haven't respected the decisions you gave to Moses your servant.
- 7 We have acted very wickedly toward you. We have not obeyed the commands, decrees and laws you gave your servant Moses.
- 8 All the same, remember the warning you posted to your servant Moses: 'If you betray me, I'll scatter you to the four winds,
- 8 Remember the instruction you gave your servant Moses, saying, 'If you are unfaithful, I will scatter you among the nations,
- 9 but if you come back to me and do what I tell you, I'll gather up all these scattered peoples from wherever they ended up and put them back in the place I chose to mark with my Name.'
- 9 but if you return to me and obey my commands, then even if your exiled people are at the farthest horizon, I will gather them from there and bring them to the place I have chosen as a dwelling for my Name.'
- 10 "Well, there they are--your servants, your people whom you so powerfully and impressively redeemed.
- 10 They are your servants and your people, whom you redeemed by your great strength and your mighty hand.
- 11 O Master, listen to me, listen to your servant's prayer--and yes, to all your servants who delight in honoring you--and make me successful today so that I get what I want from the king." I was cupbearer to the king.
- 11 O Lord, let your ear be attentive to the prayer of this your servant and to the prayer of your servants who delight in revering your name. Give your servant success today by granting him favor in the presence of this man." I was cupbearer to the king.

Nehemiah 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 It was the month of Nisan in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king. At the hour for serving wine I brought it in and gave it to the king. I had never been hangdog in his presence before,
- 1 In the month of Nisan in the twentieth year of King Artaxerxes, when wine was brought for him, I took the wine and gave it to the king. I had not been sad in his presence before;
- 2 so he asked me, "Why the long face? You're not sick are you? Or are you depressed?" That made me all the more agitated.
- 2 so the king asked me, "Why does your face look so sad when you are not ill? This can be nothing but sadness of heart." I was very much afraid,
- 3 I said, "Long live the king! And why shouldn't I be depressed when the city, the city where all my family is buried, is in ruins and the city gates have been reduced to cinders?"
- 3 but I said to the king, "May the king live forever! Why should my face not look sad when the city where my fathers are buried lies in ruins, and its gates have been destroyed by fire?"
- 4 The king then asked me, "So what do you want?" Praying under my breath to the God-of-Heaven,
- 4 The king said to me, "What is it you want?" Then I prayed to the God of heaven,
- 5 I said, "If it please the king, and if the king thinks well of me, send me to Judah, to the city where my family is buried, so that I can rebuild it."
- 5 and I answered the king, "If it pleases the king and if your servant has found favor in his sight, let him send me to the city in Judah where my fathers are buried so that I can rebuild it."
- 6 The king, with the queen sitting alongside him, said, "How long will your work take and when would you expect to return?" I gave him a time, and the king gave his approval to send me.
- 6 Then the king, with the queen sitting beside him, asked me, "How long will your journey take, and when will you get back?" It pleased the king to send me; so I set a time.

- 7 Then I said, "If it please the king, provide me with letters to the governors across the Euphrates that authorize my travel through to Judah;
- 7 I also said to him, "If it pleases the king, may I have letters to the governors of Trans-Euphrates, so that they will provide me safe-conduct until I arrive in Judah?
- 8 and also an order to Asaph, keeper of the king's forest, to supply me with timber for the beams of The Temple fortress, the wall of the city, and the house where I'll be living." The generous hand of my God was with me in this and the king gave them to me.
- 8 And may I have a letter to Asaph, keeper of the king's forest, so he will give me timber to make beams for the gates of the citadel by the temple and for the city wall and for the residence I will occupy?" And because the gracious hand of my God was upon me, the king granted my requests.
- 9 When I met the governors across The River (the Euphrates) I showed them the king's letters. The king even sent along a cavalry escort.
- 9 So I went to the governors of Trans-Euphrates and gave them the king's letters. The king had also sent army officers and cavalry with me.
- 10 When Sanballat the Horonite and Tobiah the Ammonite official heard about this, they were very upset, angry that anyone would come to look after the interests of the People of Israel.
- 10 When Sanballat the Horonite and Tobiah the Ammonite official heard about this, they were very much disturbed that someone had come to promote the welfare of the Israelites.
- 11 And so I arrived in Jerusalem. After I had been there three days,
- 11 I went to Jerusalem, and after staying there three days
- 12 I got up in the middle of the night, I and a few men who were with me. I hadn't told anyone what my God had put in my heart to do for Jerusalem. The only animal with us was the one I was riding.
- 12 I set out during the night with a few men. I had not told anyone what my God had put in my heart to do for Jerusalem. There were no mounts with me except the one I was riding on.
- 13 Under cover of night I went past the Valley Gate toward the Dragon's Fountain to the Dung Gate looking over the walls of Jerusalem, which had been broken through and whose gates had been burned up.

- 13 By night I went out through the Valley Gate toward the Jackal Well and the Dung Gate, examining the walls of Jerusalem, which had been broken down, and its gates, which had been destroyed by fire.
- 14 I then crossed to the Fountain Gate and headed for the King's Pool but there wasn't enough room for the donkey I was riding to get through.
- 14 Then I moved on toward the Fountain Gate and the King's Pool, but there was not enough room for my mount to get through;
- 15 So I went up the valley in the dark continuing my inspection of the wall. I came back in through the Valley Gate.
- 15 so I went up the valley by night, examining the wall. Finally, I turned back and reentered through the Valley Gate.
- 16 The local officials had no idea where I'd gone or what I was doing--I hadn't breathed a word to the Jews, priests, nobles, local officials, or anyone else who would be working on the job.
- 16 The officials did not know where I had gone or what I was doing, because as yet I had said nothing to the Jews or the priests or nobles or officials or any others who would be doing the work.
- 17 Then I gave them my report: "Face it: we're in a bad way here. Jerusalem is a wreck; its gates are burned up. Come--let's build the wall of Jerusalem and not live with this disgrace any longer."
- 17 Then I said to them, "You see the trouble we are in: Jerusalem lies in ruins, and its gates have been burned with fire. Come, let us rebuild the wall of Jerusalem, and we will no longer be in disgrace."
- 18 I told them how God was supporting me and how the king was backing me up. They said, "We're with you. Let's get started." They rolled up their sleeves, ready for the good work.
- 18 I also told them about the gracious hand of my God upon me and what the king had said to me. They replied, "Let us start rebuilding." So they began this good work.
- 19 When Sanballat the Horonite, Tobiah the Ammonite official, and Geshem the Arab heard about it, they laughed at us, mocking, "Ha! What do you think you're doing? Do you think you can cross the king?"
- 19 But when Sanballat the Horonite, Tobiah the Ammonite official and Geshem the Arab heard about it, they mocked and ridiculed us. "What is this you are doing?" they asked. "Are you rebelling against the king?"

- 20 I shot back, "The God-of-Heaven will make sure we succeed. We're his servants and we're going to work, rebuilding. You can keep your nose out of it. You get no say in this--Jerusalem's none of your business!"
- 20 I answered them by saying, "The God of heaven will give us success. We his servants will start rebuilding, but as for you, you have no share in Jerusalem or any claim or historic right to it."

Nehemiah 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 The high priest Eliashib and his fellow priests were up and at it: They went to work on the Sheep Gate; they repaired it and hung its doors, continuing on as far as the Tower of the Hundred and the Tower of Hananel.
- 1 Eliashib the high priest and his fellow priests went to work and rebuilt the Sheep Gate. They dedicated it and set its doors in place, building as far as the Tower of the Hundred, which they dedicated, and as far as the Tower of Hananel.
- 2 The men of Jericho worked alongside them; and next to them, Zaccur son of Imri.
- 2 The men of Jericho built the adjoining section, and Zaccur son of Imri built next to them.
- 3 The Fish Gate was built by the Hassenaah brothers; they repaired it, hung its doors, and installed its bolts and bars.
- 3 The Fish Gate was rebuilt by the sons of Hassenaah. They laid its beams and put its doors and bolts and bars in place.
- 4 Meremoth son of Uriah, the son of Hakkoz, worked; next to him Meshullam son of Berekiah, the son of Meshezabel; next to him Zadok son of Baana;
- 4 Meremoth son of Uriah, the son of Hakkoz, repaired the next section. Next to him Meshullam son of Berekiah, the son of Meshezabel, made repairs, and next to him Zadok son of Baana also made repairs.
- 5 and next to him the Tekoites (except for their nobles, who wouldn't work with their master and refused to get their hands dirty with such work).

- 5 The next section was repaired by the men of Tekoa, but their nobles would not put their shoulders to the work under their supervisors.
- 6 The Jeshanah Gate was rebuilt by Joiada son of Paseah and Meshullam son of Besodeiah; they repaired it, hung its doors, and installed its bolts and bars.
- 6 The Jeshanah Gate was repaired by Joiada son of Paseah and Meshullam son of Besodeiah. They laid its beams and put its doors and bolts and bars in place.
- 7 Melatiah the Gibeonite, Jadon the Meronothite, and the men of Gibeon and Mizpah, which was under the rule of the governor from across the Euphrates, worked alongside them.
- 7 Next to them, repairs were made by men from Gibeon and Mizpah--Melatiah of Gibeon and Jadon of Meronoth--places under the authority of the governor of Trans-Euphrates.
- 8 Uzziel son of Harhaiah of the goldsmiths' guild worked next to him, and next to him Hananiah, one of the perfumers. They rebuilt the wall of Jerusalem as far as the Broad Wall.
- 8 Uzziel son of Harhaiah, one of the goldsmiths, repaired the next section; and Hananiah, one of the perfume-makers, made repairs next to that. They restored Jerusalem as far as the Broad Wall.
- 9 The next section was worked on by Rephaiah son of Hur, mayor of a half-district of Jerusalem.
- 9 Rephaiah son of Hur, ruler of a half-district of Jerusalem, repaired the next section.
- 10 Next to him Jedaiah son of Harumaph rebuilt the front of his house; Hattush son of Hashabneiah worked next to him.
- 10 Adjoining this, Jedaiah son of Harumaph made repairs opposite his house, and Hattush son of Hashabneiah made repairs next to him.
- 11 Malkijah son of Harim and Hasshub son of Pahath-Moab rebuilt another section that included the Tower of Furnaces.
- 11 Malkijah son of Harim and Hasshub son of Pahath-Moab repaired another section and the Tower of the Ovens.
- 12 Working next to him was Shallum son of Hallohesh, mayor of the other half-district of Jerusalem, along with his daughters.
- 12 Shallum son of Hallohesh, ruler of a half-district of Jerusalem, repaired the next section with the help of his daughters.

- 13 The Valley Gate was rebuilt by Hanun and villagers of Zanoah; they repaired it, hung its doors, and installed its bolts and bars. They went on to repair 1,500 feet of the wall, as far as the Dung Gate.
- 13 The Valley Gate was repaired by Hanun and the residents of Zanoah. They rebuilt it and put its doors and bolts and bars in place. They also repaired five hundred yards of the wall as far as the Dung Gate.
- 14 The Dung Gate itself was rebuilt by Malkijah son of Recab, the mayor of the district of Beth Hakkerem; he repaired it, hung its doors, and installed its bolts and bars.
- 14 The Dung Gate was repaired by Malkijah son of Recab, ruler of the district of Beth Hakkerem. He rebuilt it and put its doors and bolts and bars in place.
- 15 The Fountain Gate was rebuilt by Shallun son of Col-Hozeh, mayor of the Mizpah district; he repaired it, roofed it, hung its doors, and installed its bolts and bars. He also rebuilt the wall of the Pool of Siloam at the King's Garden as far as the steps that go down from the City of David.
- 15 The Fountain Gate was repaired by Shallun son of Col- Hozeh, ruler of the district of Mizpah. He rebuilt it, roofing it over and putting its doors and bolts and bars in place. He also repaired the wall of the Pool of Siloam, by the King's Garden, as far as the steps going down from the City of David.
- 16 After him came Nehemiah son of Azbuk, mayor of half the district of Beth Zur. He worked from just in front of the Tomb of David as far as the Pool and the House of Heroes.
- 16 Beyond him, Nehemiah son of Azbuk, ruler of a half-district of Beth Zur, made repairs up to a point opposite the tombs of David, as far as the artificial pool and the House of the Heroes.
- 17 Levites under Rehum son of Bani were next in line. Alongside them, Hashabiah, mayor of half the district of Keilah, represented his district in the rebuilding.
- 17 Next to him, the repairs were made by the Levites under Rehum son of Bani. Beside him, Hashabiah, ruler of half the district of Keilah, carried out repairs for his district.
- 18 Next to him their brothers continued the rebuilding under Binnui son of Henadad, mayor of the other half-district of Keilah.

- 18 Next to him, the repairs were made by their countrymen under Binnui son of Henadad, ruler of the other half-district of Keilah.
- 19 The section from in front of the Ascent to the Armory as far as the Angle was rebuilt by Ezer son of Jeshua, the mayor of Mizpah.
- 19 Next to him, Ezer son of Jeshua, ruler of Mizpah, repaired another section, from a point facing the ascent to the armory as far as the angle.
- 20 From the Angle to the door of the house of Eliashib the high priest was done by Baruch son of Zabbai.
- 20 Next to him, Baruch son of Zabbai zealously repaired another section, from the angle to the entrance of the house of Eliashib the high priest.
- 21 Meremoth son of Uriah, the son of Hakkoz, took it from the door of Eliashib's house to the end of Eliashib's house.
- 21 Next to him, Meremoth son of Uriah, the son of Hakkoz, repaired another section, from the entrance of Eliashib's house to the end of it.
- 22 Priests from the neighborhood went on from there.
- 22 The repairs next to him were made by the priests from the surrounding region.
- 23 Benjamin and Hasshub worked on the wall in front of their house, and Azariah son of Maaseiah, the son of Ananiah, did the work alongside his house.
- 23 Beyond them, Benjamin and Hasshub made repairs in front of their house; and next to them, Azariah son of Maaseiah, the son of Ananiah, made repairs beside his house.
- 24 The section from the house of Azariah to the Angle at the Corner was rebuilt by Binnui son of Henadad.
- 24 Next to him, Binnui son of Henadad repaired another section, from Azariah's house to the angle and the corner,
- 25 Palal son of Uzai worked opposite the Angle and the tower that projects from the Upper Palace of the king near the Court of the Guard. Next to him Pedaiah son of Parosh
- 25 and Palal son of Uzai worked opposite the angle and the tower projecting from the upper palace near the court of the guard. Next to him, Pedaiah son of Parosh
- 26 and The Temple support staff who lived on the hill of Ophel worked up to the point opposite the Water Gate eastward and the projecting tower.

- 26 and the temple servants living on the hill of Ophel made repairs up to a point opposite the Water Gate toward the east and the projecting tower.
- 27 The men of Tekoa did the section from the great projecting tower as far as the wall of Ophel.
- 27 Next to them, the men of Tekoa repaired another section, from the great projecting tower to the wall of Ophel.
- 28 Above the Horse Gate the priests worked, each priest repairing the wall in front of his own house.
- 28 Above the Horse Gate, the priests made repairs, each in front of his own house.
- 29 After them Zadok son of Immer rebuilt in front of his house and after him Shemaiah son of Shecaniah, the keeper of the East Gate;
- 29 Next to them, Zadok son of Immer made repairs opposite his house. Next to him, Shemaiah son of Shecaniah, the guard at the East Gate, made repairs.
- 30 then Hananiah son of Shelemiah and Hanun, the sixth son of Zalaph; then Meshullam son of Berekiah rebuilt the wall in front of his storage shed.
- 30 Next to him, Hananiah son of Shelemiah, and Hanun, the sixth son of Zalaph, repaired another section. Next to them, Meshullam son of Berekiah made repairs opposite his living quarters.
- 31 Malkijah the goldsmith repaired the wall as far as the house of The Temple support staff and merchants, up to the Inspection Gate, and the Upper Room at the Corner.
- 31 Next to him, Malkijah, one of the goldsmiths, made repairs as far as the house of the temple servants and the merchants, opposite the Inspection Gate, and as far as the room above the corner;
- 32 The goldsmiths and the merchants made the repairs between the Upper Room at the Corner and the Sheep Gate.
- 32 and between the room above the corner and the Sheep Gate the goldsmiths and merchants made repairs.

Nehemiah 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 When Sanballat heard that we were rebuilding the wall he exploded in anger, vilifying the Jews.
- 1 When Sanballat heard that we were rebuilding the wall, he became angry and was greatly incensed. He ridiculed the Jews,
- 2 In the company of his Samaritan cronies and military he let loose: "What are these miserable Jews doing? Do they think they can get everything back to normal overnight? Make building stones out of make-believe?"
- 2 and in the presence of his associates and the army of Samaria, he said, "What are those feeble Jews doing? Will they restore their wall? Will they offer sacrifices? Will they finish in a day? Can they bring the stones back to life from those heaps of rubble--burned as they are?"
- 3 At his side, Tobiah the Ammonite jumped in and said, "That's right! What do they think they're building? Why, if a fox climbed that wall, it would fall to pieces under his weight."
- 3 Tobiah the Ammonite, who was at his side, said, "What they are building--if even a fox climbed up on it, he would break down their wall of stones!"
- 4 Nehemiah prayed, "Oh listen to us, dear God. We're so despised: Boomerang their ridicule on their heads; have their enemies cart them off as war trophies to a land of no return;
- 4 Hear us, O our God, for we are despised. Turn their insults back on their own heads. Give them over as plunder in a land of captivity.
- 5 don't forgive their iniquity, don't wipe away their sin--they've insulted the builders!"
- 5 Do not cover up their guilt or blot out their sins from your sight, for they have thrown insults in the face of the builders.
- 6 We kept at it, repairing and rebuilding the wall. The whole wall was soon joined together and halfway to its intended height because the people had a heart for the work.
- 6 So we rebuilt the wall till all of it reached half its height, for the people worked with all their heart.
- 7 When Sanballat, Tobiah, the Arabs, the Ammonites, and the Ashdodites heard that the repairs of the walls of Jerusalem were going so well--that the breaks in the wall were being fixed--they were absolutely furious.
- 7 But when Sanballat, Tobiah, the Arabs, the Ammonites and the men of Ashdod heard that the repairs to Jerusalem's walls had gone ahead and

- that the gaps were being closed, they were very angry.
- 8 They put their heads together and decided to fight against Jerusalem and create as much trouble as they could.
- 8 They all plotted together to come and fight against Jerusalem and stir up trouble against it.
- 9 We countered with prayer to our God and set a round-the-clock guard against them.
- 9 But we prayed to our God and posted a guard day and night to meet this threat.
- 10 But soon word was going around in Judah, The builders are pooped, the rubbish piles up; We're in over our heads, we can't build this wall.
- 10 Meanwhile, the people in Judah said, "The strength of the laborers is giving out, and there is so much rubble that we cannot rebuild the wall."
- 11 And all this time our enemies were saying, "They won't know what hit them. Before they know it we'll be at their throats, killing them right and left. That will put a stop to the work!"
- 11 Also our enemies said, "Before they know it or see us, we will be right there among them and will kill them and put an end to the work."
- 12 The Jews who were their neighbors kept reporting, "They have us surrounded; they're going to attack!" If we heard it once, we heard it ten times.
- 12 Then the Jews who lived near them came and told us ten times over, "Wherever you turn, they will attack us."
- 13 So I stationed armed guards at the most vulnerable places of the wall and assigned people by families with their swords, lances, and bows.
- 13 Therefore I stationed some of the people behind the lowest points of the wall at the exposed places, posting them by families, with their swords, spears and bows.
- 14 After looking things over I stood up and spoke to the nobles, officials, and everyone else: "Don't be afraid of them. Put your minds on the Master, great and awesome, and then fight for your brothers, your sons, your daughters, your wives, and your homes."
- 14 After I looked things over, I stood up and said to the nobles, the officials and the rest of the people, "Don't be afraid of them. Remember the Lord, who is great and awesome, and fight for your brothers, your sons and your daughters, your wives and your homes."

15 Our enemies learned that we knew all about their plan and that God had frustrated it. And we went back to the wall and went to work.

15 When our enemies heard that we were aware of their plot and that God had frustrated it, we all returned to the wall, each to his own work.

16 From then on half of my young men worked while the other half stood guard with lances, shields, bows, and mail armor. Military officers served as backup for everyone in Judah who was at work rebuilding the wall.

16 From that day on, half of my men did the work, while the other half were equipped with spears, shields, bows and armor. The officers posted themselves behind all the people of Judah

17 The common laborers held a tool in one hand and a spear in the other.

17 who were building the wall. Those who carried materials did their work with one hand and held a weapon in the other,

18 Each of the builders had a sword strapped to his side as he worked. I kept the trumpeter at my side to sound the alert.

18 and each of the builders wore his sword at his side as he worked. But the man who sounded the trumpet stayed with me.

19 Then I spoke to the nobles and officials and everyone else: "There's a lot of work going on and we are spread out all along the wall, separated from each other.

19 Then I said to the nobles, the officials and the rest of the people, "The work is extensive and spread out, and we are widely separated from each other along the wall.

20 When you hear the trumpet call, join us there; our God will fight for us."

20 Wherever you hear the sound of the trumpet, join us there. Our God will fight for us!"

21 And so we kept working, from first light until the stars came out, half of us holding lances.

21 So we continued the work with half the men holding spears, from the first light of dawn till the stars came out.

22 I also instructed the people, "Each person and his helper is to stay inside Jerusalem--guards by night and workmen by day."

22 At that time I also said to the people, "Have every man and his helper stay inside Jerusalem at night, so they can serve us as guards by night

and workmen by day."

23 We all slept in our clothes--I, my brothers, my workmen, and the guards backing me up. And each one kept his spear in his hand, even when getting water.

23 Neither I nor my brothers nor my men nor the guards with me took off our clothes; each had his weapon, even when he went for water.

Nehemiah 5

MSG

NIV

1 A great protest was mounted by the people, including the wives, against their fellow Jews.

1 Now the men and their wives raised a great outcry against their Jewish brothers.

2 Some said, "We have big families, and we need food just to survive."

2 Some were saying, "We and our sons and daughters are numerous; in order for us to eat and stay alive, we must get grain."

3 Others said, "We're having to mortgage our fields and vineyards and homes to get enough grain to keep from starving."

3 Others were saying, "We are mortgaging our fields, our vineyards and our homes to get grain during the famine."

4 And others said, "We're having to borrow money to pay the royal tax on our fields and vineyards."

4 Still others were saying, "We have had to borrow money to pay the king's tax on our fields and vineyards."

5 Look: We're the same flesh and blood as our brothers here; our children are just as good as theirs. Yet here we are having to sell our children off as slaves--some of our daughters have already been sold--and we can't do anything about it because our fields and vineyards are owned by somebody else."

5 Although we are of the same flesh and blood as our countrymen and though our sons are as good as theirs, yet we have to subject our sons and daughters to slavery. Some of our daughters have already been enslaved, but we are powerless, because our fields and our vineyards belong to others."

- 6 I got really angry when I heard their protest and complaints.
- 6 When I heard their outcry and these charges, I was very angry.
- 7 After thinking it over, I called the nobles and officials on the carpet. I said, "Each one of you is gouging his brother." Then I called a big meeting to deal with them.
- 7 I pondered them in my mind and then accused the nobles and officials. I told them, "You are exacting usury from your own countrymen!" So I called together a large meeting to deal with them
- 8 I told them, "We did everything we could to buy back our Jewish brothers who had to sell themselves as slaves to foreigners. And now you're selling these same brothers back into debt slavery! Does that mean that we have to buy them back again?" They said nothing. What could they say?
- 8 and said: "As far as possible, we have bought back our Jewish brothers who were sold to the Gentiles. Now you are selling your brothers, only for them to be sold back to us!" They kept quiet, because they could find nothing to say.
- 9 "What you're doing is wrong. Is there no fear of God left in you? Don't you care what the nations around here, our enemies, think of you?
- 9 So I continued, "What you are doing is not right. Shouldn't you walk in the fear of our God to avoid the reproach of our Gentile enemies?
- 10 "I and my brothers and the people working for me have also loaned them money. But this gouging them with interest has to stop.
- 10 I and my brothers and my men are also lending the people money and grain. But let the exacting of usury stop!
- 11 Give them back their foreclosed fields, vineyards, olive groves, and homes right now. And forgive your claims on their money, grain, new wine, and olive oil."
- 11 Give back to them immediately their fields, vineyards, olive groves and houses, and also the usury you are charging them--the hundredth part of the money, grain, new wine and oil."
- 12 They said, "We'll give it all back. We won't make any more demands on them. We'll do everything you say." Then I called the priests together and made them promise to keep their word.
- 12 We will give it back, they said. "And we will not demand anything more from them. We will do as you say." Then I summoned the priests and

- made the nobles and officials take an oath to do what they had promised.
- 13 Then I emptied my pockets, turning them inside out, and said, "So may God empty the pockets and house of everyone who doesn't keep this promise--turned inside out and emptied." Everyone gave a wholehearted "Yes, we'll do it!" and praised GOD. And the people did what they promised.
- 13 I also shook out the folds of my robe and said, "In this way may God shake out of his house and possessions every man who does not keep this promise. So may such a man be shaken out and emptied!" At this the whole assembly said, "Amen," and praised the LORD. And the people did as they had promised.
- 14 From the time King Artaxerxes appointed me as their governor in the land of Judah--from the twentieth to the thirty-second year of his reign, twelve years--neither I nor my brothers used the governor's food allowance.
- 14 Moreover, from the twentieth year of King Artaxerxes, when I was appointed to be their governor in the land of Judah, until his thirty-second year--twelve years--neither I nor my brothers ate the food allotted to the governor.
- 15 Governors who had preceded me had oppressed the people by taxing them forty shekels of silver (about a pound) a day for food and wine while their underlings bullied the people unmercifully. But out of fear of God I did none of that.
- 15 But the earlier governors--those preceding me--placed a heavy burden on the people and took forty shekels of silver from them in addition to food and wine. Their assistants also lorded it over the people. But out of reverence for God I did not act like that.
- 16 I had work to do; I worked on this wall. All my men were on the job to do the work. We didn't have time to line our own pockets.
- 16 Instead, I devoted myself to the work on this wall. All my men were assembled there for the work; we did not acquire any land.
- 17 I fed one hundred and fifty Jews and officials at my table in addition to those who showed up from the surrounding nations.
- 17 Furthermore, a hundred and fifty Jews and officials ate at my table, as well as those who came to us from the surrounding nations.

18 One ox, six choice sheep, and some chickens were prepared for me daily, and every ten days a large supply of wine was delivered. Even so, I didn't use the food allowance provided for the governor--the people had it hard enough as it was.

18 Each day one ox, six choice sheep and some poultry were prepared for me, and every ten days an abundant supply of wine of all kinds. In spite of all this, I never demanded the food allotted to the governor, because the demands were heavy on these people.

19 Remember in my favor, O my God, Everything I've done for these people.

19 Remember me with favor, O my God, for all I have done for these people.

Nehemiah 6

MSG

NIV

1 When Sanballat, Tobiah, Geshem the Arab, and the rest of our enemies heard that I had rebuilt the wall and that there were no more breaks in it--even though I hadn't yet installed the gates--

1 When word came to Sanballat, Tobiah, Geshem the Arab and the rest of our enemies that I had rebuilt the wall and not a gap was left in it--though up to that time I had not set the doors in the gates--

2 Sanballat and Geshem sent this message: "Come and meet with us at Kephirim in the valley of Ono." I knew they were scheming to hurt me

2 Sanballat and Geshem sent me this message: "Come, let us meet together in one of the villages on the plain of Ono." But they were scheming to harm me;

3 so I sent messengers back with this: "I'm doing a great work; I can't come down. Why should the work come to a standstill just so I can come down to see you?"

3 so I sent messengers to them with this reply: "I am carrying on a great project and cannot go down. Why should the work stop while I leave it and go down to you?"

4 Four times they sent this message and four times I gave them my answer.

- 4 Four times they sent me the same message, and each time I gave them the same answer.
- 5 The fifth time--same messenger, same message--Sanballat sent an unsealed letter
- 5 Then, the fifth time, Sanballat sent his aide to me with the same message, and in his hand was an unsealed letter
- 6 with this message: "The word is out among the nations--and Geshem says it's true--that you and the Jews are planning to rebel. That's why you are rebuilding the wall. The word is that you want to be king
- 6 in which was written: "It is reported among the nations--and Geshem says it is true-- that you and the Jews are plotting to revolt, and therefore you are building the wall. Moreover, according to these reports you are about to become their king
- 7 and that you have appointed prophets to announce in Jerusalem, 'There's a king in Judah!' The king is going to be told all this--don't you think we should sit down and have a talk?"
- 7 and have even appointed prophets to make this proclamation about you in Jerusalem: 'There is a king in Judah!' Now this report will get back to the king; so come, let us confer together."
- 8 I sent him back this: "There's nothing to what you're saying. You've made it all up."
- 8 I sent him this reply: "Nothing like what you are saying is happening; you are just making it up out of your head."
- 9 They were trying to intimidate us into quitting. They thought, "They'll give up; they'll never finish it." I prayed, "Give me strength."
- 9 They were all trying to frighten us, thinking, "Their hands will get too weak for the work, and it will not be completed." But I prayed, "Now strengthen my hands."
- 10 Then I met secretly with Shemaiah son of Delaiah, the son of Mehetabel, at his house. He said: Let's meet at the house of God, inside The Temple; Let's find safety behind locked doors because they're coming to kill you, Yes, coming by night to kill you.
- 10 One day I went to the house of Shemaiah son of Delaiah, the son of Mehetabel, who was shut in at his home. He said, "Let us meet in the house of God, inside the temple, and let us close the temple doors,

because men are coming to kill you--by night they are coming to kill you."

11 I said, "Why would a man like me run for cover? And why would a man like me use The Temple as a hideout? I won't do it."

11 But I said, "Should a man like me run away? Or should one like me go into the temple to save his life? I will not go!"

12 I sensed that God hadn't sent this man. The so-called prophecy he spoke to me was the work of Tobiah and Sanballat; they had hired him.

12 I realized that God had not sent him, but that he had prophesied against me because Tobiah and Sanballat had hired him.

13 He had been hired to scare me off--trick me--a layman, into desecrating The Temple and ruining my good reputation so they could accuse me.

13 He had been hired to intimidate me so that I would commit a sin by doing this, and then they would give me a bad name to discredit me.

14 "O my God, don't let Tobiah and Sanballat get by with all the mischief they've done. And the same goes for the prophetess Noadiah and the other prophets who have been trying to undermine my confidence."

14 Remember Tobiah and Sanballat, O my God, because of what they have done; remember also the prophetess Noadiah and the rest of the prophets who have been trying to intimidate me.

15 The wall was finished on the twenty-fifth day of Elul. It had taken fifty-two days.

15 So the wall was completed on the twenty-fifth of Elul, in fifty-two days.

16 When all our enemies heard the news and all the surrounding nations saw it, our enemies totally lost their nerve. They knew that God was behind this work.

16 When all our enemies heard about this, all the surrounding nations were afraid and lost their self-confidence, because they realized that this work had been done with the help of our God.

17 All during this time letters were going back and forth constantly between the nobles of Judah and Tobiah.

17 Also, in those days the nobles of Judah were sending many letters to Tobiah, and replies from Tobiah kept coming to them.

18 Many of the nobles had ties to him because he was son-in-law to Shecaniah son of Arah and his son Jehohanan had married the daughter of Meshullam son of Berekiah.

- 18 For many in Judah were under oath to him, since he was son-in-law to Shecaniah son of Arah, and his son Jehohanan had married the daughter of Meshullam son of Berekiah.
- 19 They kept telling me all the good things he did and then would report back to him anything I would say. And then Tobiah would send letters to intimidate me.
- 19 Moreover, they kept reporting to me his good deeds and then telling him what I said. And Tobiah sent letters to intimidate me.

Nehemiah 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 After the wall was rebuilt and I had installed the doors, and the security guards, the singers, and the Levites were appointed,
- 1 After the wall had been rebuilt and I had set the doors in place, the gatekeepers and the singers and the Levites were appointed.
- 2 I put my brother Hanani, along with Hananiah the captain of the citadel, in charge of Jerusalem because he was an honest man and feared God more than most men.
- 2 I put in charge of Jerusalem my brother Hanani, along with Hananiah the commander of the citadel, because he was a man of integrity and feared God more than most men do.
- 3 I gave them this order: "Don't open the gates of Jerusalem until the sun is up. And shut and bar the gates while the guards are still on duty. Appoint the guards from the citizens of Jerusalem and assign them to posts in front of their own homes."
- 3 I said to them, "The gates of Jerusalem are not to be opened until the sun is hot. While the gatekeepers are still on duty, have them shut the doors and bar them. Also appoint residents of Jerusalem as guards, some at their posts and some near their own houses."
- 4 The city was large and spacious with only a few people in it and the houses not yet rebuilt.
- 4 Now the city was large and spacious, but there were few people in it, and the houses had not yet been rebuilt.

- 5 God put it in my heart to gather the nobles, the officials, and the people in general to be registered. I found the genealogical record of those who were in the first return from exile. This is the record I found:
- 5 So my God put it into my heart to assemble the nobles, the officials and the common people for registration by families. I found the genealogical record of those who had been the first to return. This is what I found written there:
- 6 These are the people of the province who returned from the captivity of the Exile, the ones Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried off captive; they came back to Jerusalem and Judah, each going to his own town.
- 6 These are the people of the province who came up from the captivity of the exiles whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had taken captive (they returned to Jerusalem and Judah, each to his own town,
- 7 They came back in the company of Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai, Nehum, and Baanah. The numbers of the men of the People of Israel by families of origin:
- 7 in company with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai, Nehum and Baanah):
The list of the men of Israel:
- 8 Parosh, 2,172
- 8 the descendants of Parosh 2,172
- 9 Shephatiah, 372
- 9 of Shephatiah 372
- 10 Arah, 652
- 10 of Arah 652
- 11 Pahath-Moab (sons of Jeshua and Joab), 2,818
- 11 of Pahath-Moab (through the line of Jeshua and Joab) 2,818
- 12 Elam, 1,254
- 12 of Elam 1,254
- 13 Zattu, 845
- 13 of Zattu 845
- 14 Zaccai, 760
- 14 of Zaccai 760
- 15 Binnui, 648

15 of Binnui 648
16 Bebai, 628
16 of Bebai 628
17 Azgad, 2,322
17 of Azgad 2,322
18 Adonikam, 667
18 of Adonikam 667
19 Bigvai, 2,067
19 of Bigvai 2,067
20 Adin, 655
20 of Adin 655
21 Ater (sons of Hezekiah), 98
21 of Ater (through Hezekiah) 98
22 Hashum, 328
22 of Hashum 328
23 Bezai, 324
23 of Bezai 324
24 Hariph, 112
24 of Hariph 112
25 Gibeon, 95.
25 of Gibeon 95
26 Israelites identified by place of origin: Bethlehem and Netophah, 188
26 the men of Bethlehem and Netophah 188
27 Anathoth, 128
27 of Anathoth 128
28 Beth Azmaveth, 42
28 of Beth Azmaveth 42
29 Kiriath Jearim, Kephirah, and Beeroth, 743
29 of Kiriath Jearim, Kephirah and Beeroth 743
30 Ramah and Geba, 621
30 of Ramah and Geba 621
31 Micmash, 122
31 of Micmash 122
32 Bethel and Ai, 123
32 of Bethel and Ai 123
33 Nebo (the other one), 52

- 33 of the other Nebo 52
- 34 Elam (the other one), 1,254
- 34 of the other Elam 1,254
- 35 Harim, 320
- 35 of Harim 320
- 36 Jericho, 345
- 36 of Jericho 345
- 37 Lod, Hadid, and Ono, 721
- 37 of Lod, Hadid and Ono 721
- 38 Senaah, 3,930.
- 38 of Senaah 3,930
- 39 Priestly families: Jedaiah (sons of Jeshua), 973
- 39 The priests: the descendants of Jedaiah (through the family of Jeshua) 973
- 40 Immer, 1,052
- 40 of Immer 1,052
- 41 Pashhur, 1,247
- 41 of Pashhur 1,247
- 42 Harim, 1,017.
- 42 of Harim 1,017
- 43 Levitical families: Jeshua (sons of Kadmiel and of Hodaviah), 74.
- 43 The Levites: the descendants of Jeshua (through Kadmiel through the line of Hodaviah) 74
- 44 Singers: Asaph's family line, 148.
- 44 The singers: the descendants of Asaph 148
- 45 Security guard families: Shallum, Ater, Talmon, Akkub, Hatita, and Shobai, 138.
- 45 The gatekeepers: the descendants of Shallum, Ater, Talmon, Akkub, Hatita and Shobai 138
- 46 Families of support staff: Ziha, Hasupha, Tabbaoth,
- 46 The temple servants: the descendants of Ziha, Hasupha, Tabbaoth,
- 47 Keros, Sia, Padon,
- 47 Keros, Sia, Padon,
- 48 Lebana, Hagaba, Shalmal,
- 48 Lebana, Hagaba, Shalmal,
- 49 Hanan, Giddel, Gahar,

49 Hanan, Giddel, Gahar,
 50 Reaiah, Rezin, Nekoda,
 50 Reaiah, Rezin, Nekoda,
 51 Gazzam, Uzza, Paseah,
 51 Gazzam, Uzza, Paseah,
 52 Besai, Meunim, Nephussim,
 52 Besai, Meunim, Nephussim,
 53 Bakbuk, Hakupha, Harhur,
 53 Bakbuk, Hakupha, Harhur,
 54 Bazluth, Mehida, Harsha,
 54 Bazluth, Mehida, Harsha,
 55 Barkos, Sisera, Temah,
 55 Barkos, Sisera, Temah,
 56 Neziah, and Hatipha.
 56 Neziah and Hatipha
 57 Families of Solomon's servants: Sotai, Sophereth, Perida,
 57 The descendants of the servants of Solomon: the descendants of Sotai,
 Sophereth, Perida,
 58 Jaala, Darkon, Giddel,
 58 Jaala, Darkon, Giddel,
 59 Shephatiah, Hattil, Pokereth-Hazzebaim, and Amon.
 59 Shephatiah, Hattil, Pokereth-Hazzebaim and Amon
 60 The Temple support staff and Solomon's servants added up to 392.
 60 The temple servants and the descendants of the servants of Solomon
 392
 61 These are those who came from Tel Melah, Tel Harsha, Kerub, Addon,
 and Immer. They weren't able to prove their ancestry, whether they were
 true Israelites or not:
 61 The following came up from the towns of Tel Melah, Tel Harsha,
 Kerub, Addon and Immer, but they could not show that their families
 were descended from Israel:
 62 The sons of Delaiah, Tobiah, and Nekoda, 642.
 62 the descendants of Delaiah, Tobiah and Nekoda 642
 63 Likewise with these priestly families: -The sons of Hobaiah, Hakkoz,
 and Barzillai, who had married a daughter of Barzillai the Gileadite and
 took that name.

63 And from among the priests: the descendants of Hobaiah, Hakkoz and Barzillai (a man who had married a daughter of Barzillai the Gileadite and was called by that name).

64 They looked high and low for their family records but couldn't find them. And so they were barred from priestly work as ritually unclean.

64 These searched for their family records, but they could not find them and so were excluded from the priesthood as unclean.

65 The governor ruled that they could not eat from the holy food until a priest could determine their status by using the Urim and Thummim.

65 The governor, therefore, ordered them not to eat any of the most sacred food until there should be a priest ministering with the Urim and Thummim.

66 The total count for the congregation was 42,360.

66 The whole company numbered 42,360,

67 That did not include the male and female slaves who numbered 7,337. There were also 245 male and female singers.

67 besides their 7,337 menservants and maidservants; and they also had 245 men and women singers.

68 And there were 736 horses, 245 mules,

68 There were 736 horses, 245 mules,

69 435 camels, and 6,720 donkeys.

69 435 camels and 6,720 donkeys.

70 Some of the heads of families made voluntary offerings for the work. The governor made a gift to the treasury of 1,000 drachmas of gold (about nineteen pounds), 50 bowls, and 530 garments for the priests.

70 Some of the heads of the families contributed to the work. The governor gave to the treasury 1,000 drachmas of gold, 50 bowls and 530 garments for priests.

71 Some of the heads of the families made gifts to the treasury for the work; it came to 20,000 drachmas of gold and 2,200 minas of silver (about one and a third tons).

71 Some of the heads of the families gave to the treasury for the work 20,000 drachmas of gold and 2,200 minas of silver.

72 Gifts from the rest of the people totaled 20,000 drachmas of gold (about 375 pounds), 2,000 minas of silver, and 67 garments for the priests.

- 72 The total given by the rest of the people was 20,000 drachmas of gold, 2,000 minas of silver and 67 garments for priests.
- 73 The priests, Levites, security guards, singers, and Temple support staff, along with some others, and the rest of the People of Israel, all found a place to live in their own towns.
- 73 The priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, the singers and the temple servants, along with certain of the people and the rest of the Israelites, settled in their own towns. When the seventh month came and the Israelites had settled in their towns,

Nehemiah 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 By the time the seventh month arrived, the People of Israel were settled in their towns. Then all the people gathered as one person in the town square in front of the Water Gate and asked the scholar Ezra to bring the Book of The Revelation of Moses that GOD had commanded for Israel.
- 1 all the people assembled as one man in the square before the Water Gate. They told Ezra the scribe to bring out the Book of the Law of Moses, which the LORD had commanded for Israel.
- 2 So Ezra the priest brought The Revelation to the congregation, which was made up of both men and women--everyone capable of understanding. It was the first day of the seventh month.
- 2 So on the first day of the seventh month Ezra the priest brought the Law before the assembly, which was made up of men and women and all who were able to understand.
- 3 He read it facing the town square at the Water Gate from early dawn until noon in the hearing of the men and women, all who could understand it. And all the people listened--they were all ears--to the Book of The Revelation.
- 3 He read it aloud from daybreak till noon as he faced the square before the Water Gate in the presence of the men, women and others who could understand. And all the people listened attentively to the Book of the Law.

- 4 The scholar Ezra stood on a wooden platform constructed for the occasion. He was flanked on the right by Mattithiah, Shema, Anaiah, Uriah, Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, and on the left by Pedaiah, Mishael, Malkijah, Hashum, Hashbaddanah, Zechariah, and Meshullam.
- 4 Ezra the scribe stood on a high wooden platform built for the occasion. Beside him on his right stood Mattithiah, Shema, Anaiah, Uriah, Hilkiah and Maaseiah; and on his left were Pedaiah, Mishael, Malkijah, Hashum, Hashbaddanah, Zechariah and Meshullam.
- 5 Ezra opened the book. Every eye was on him (he was standing on the raised platform) and as he opened the book everyone stood.
- 5 Ezra opened the book. All the people could see him because he was standing above them; and as he opened it, the people all stood up.
- 6 Then Ezra praised GOD, the great God, and all the people responded, "Oh Yes! Yes!" with hands raised high. And then they fell to their knees in worship of GOD, their faces to the ground.
- 6 Ezra praised the LORD, the great God; and all the people lifted their hands and responded, "Amen! Amen!" Then they bowed down and worshiped the LORD with their faces to the ground.
- 7 Jeshua, Bani, Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodiah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, and Pelaiah, all Levites, explained The Revelation while people stood, listening respectfully.
- 7 The Levites--Jeshua, Bani, Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodiah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan and Pelaiah--instructed the people in the Law while the people were standing there.
- 8 They translated the Book of The Revelation of God so the people could understand it and then explained the reading.
- 8 They read from the Book of the Law of God, making it clear and giving the meaning so that the people could understand what was being read.
- 9 Nehemiah the governor, along with Ezra the priest and scholar and the Levites who were teaching the people, said to all the people, "This day is holy to GOD, your God. Don't weep and carry on." They said this because all the people were weeping as they heard the words of The Revelation.
- 9 Then Nehemiah the governor, Ezra the priest and scribe, and the Levites who were instructing the people said to them all, "This day is sacred to

- the LORD your God. Do not mourn or weep." For all the people had been weeping as they listened to the words of the Law.
- 10 He continued, "Go home and prepare a feast, holiday food and drink; and share it with those who don't have anything: This day is holy to God. Don't feel bad. The joy of GOD is your strength!"
- 10 Nehemiah said, "Go and enjoy choice food and sweet drinks, and send some to those who have nothing prepared. This day is sacred to our Lord. Do not grieve, for the joy of the LORD is your strength."
- 11 The Levites calmed the people, "Quiet now. This is a holy day. Don't be upset."
- 11 The Levites calmed all the people, saying, "Be still, for this is a sacred day. Do not grieve."
- 12 So the people went off to feast, eating and drinking and including the poor in a great celebration. Now they got it; they understood the reading that had been given to them.
- 12 Then all the people went away to eat and drink, to send portions of food and to celebrate with great joy, because they now understood the words that had been made known to them.
- 13 On the second day of the month the family heads of all the people, the priests, and the Levites gathered around Ezra the scholar to get a deeper understanding of the words of The Revelation.
- 13 On the second day of the month, the heads of all the families, along with the priests and the Levites, gathered around Ezra the scribe to give attention to the words of the Law.
- 14 They found written in The Revelation that GOD commanded through Moses that the People of Israel are to live in booths during the festival of the seventh month.
- 14 They found written in the Law, which the LORD had commanded through Moses, that the Israelites were to live in booths during the feast of the seventh month
- 15 So they published this decree and had it posted in all their cities and in Jerusalem: "Go into the hills and collect olive branches, pine branches, myrtle branches, palm branches, and any other leafy branches to make booths, as it is written."
- 15 and that they should proclaim this word and spread it throughout their towns and in Jerusalem: "Go out into the hill country and bring back

- branches from olive and wild olive trees, and from myrtles, palms and shade trees, to make booths"--as it is written.
- 16 So the people went out, brought in branches, and made themselves booths on their roofs, courtyards, the courtyards of The Temple of God, the Water Gate plaza, and the Ephraim Gate plaza.
- 16 So the people went out and brought back branches and built themselves booths on their own roofs, in their courtyards, in the courts of the house of God and in the square by the Water Gate and the one by the Gate of Ephraim.
- 17 The entire congregation that had come back from exile made booths and lived in them. The People of Israel hadn't done this from the time of Joshua son of Nun until that very day--a terrific day! Great joy!
- 17 The whole company that had returned from exile built booths and lived in them. From the days of Joshua son of Nun until that day, the Israelites had not celebrated it like this. And their joy was very great.
- 18 Ezra read from the Book of The Revelation of God each day, from the first to the last day--they celebrated the feast for seven days. On the eighth day they held a solemn assembly in accordance with the decree.
- 18 Day after day, from the first day to the last, Ezra read from the Book of the Law of God. They celebrated the feast for seven days, and on the eighth day, in accordance with the regulation, there was an assembly.

Nehemiah 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then on the twenty-fourth day of this month, the People of Israel gathered for a fast, wearing burlap and faces smudged with dirt as signs of repentance.
- 1 On the twenty-fourth day of the same month, the Israelites gathered together, fasting and wearing sackcloth and having dust on their heads.
- 2 The Israelites broke off all relations with foreigners, stood up, and confessed their sins and the iniquities of their parents.
- 2 Those of Israelite descent had separated themselves from all foreigners. They stood in their places and confessed their sins and the wickedness of their fathers.

- 3 While they stood there in their places, they read from the Book of The Revelation of GOD, their God, for a quarter of the day. For another quarter of the day they confessed and worshiped their GOD.
- 3 They stood where they were and read from the Book of the Law of the LORD their God for a quarter of the day, and spent another quarter in confession and in worshipping the LORD their God.
- 4 A group of Levites--Jeshua, Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Kenani--stood on the platform and cried out to GOD, their God, in a loud voice.
- 4 Standing on the stairs were the Levites--Jeshua, Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani and Kenani--who called with loud voices to the LORD their God.
- 5 The Levites Jeshua, Kadmiel, Bani, Hashabneiah, Sherebiah, Hodiah, Shebaniah, and Pethahiah said, "On your feet! Bless GOD, your God, for ever and ever!" Blessed be your glorious name, exalted above all blessing and praise!
- 5 And the Levites-- Jeshua, Kadmiel, Bani, Hashabneiah, Sherebiah, Hodiah, Shebaniah and Pethahiah--said: "Stand up and praise the LORD your God, who is from everlasting to everlasting. " "Blessed be your glorious name, and may it be exalted above all blessing and praise.
- 6 You're the one, GOD, you alone; You made the heavens, the heavens of heavens, and all angels; The earth and everything on it, the seas and everything in them; You keep them all alive; heaven's angels worship you!
- 6 You alone are the LORD. You made the heavens, even the highest heavens, and all their starry host, the earth and all that is on it, the seas and all that is in them. You give life to everything, and the multitudes of heaven worship you.
- 7 You're the one, GOD, the God who chose Abram And brought him from Ur of the Chaldees and changed his name to Abraham.
- 7 You are the LORD God, who chose Abram and brought him out of Ur of the Chaldeans and named him Abraham.
- 8 You found his heart to be steady and true to you and signed a covenant with him, A covenant to give him the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, and the Amorites, The Perizzites, Jebusites, and Girgashites, --to give it to his descendants. And you kept your word because you are righteous.

- 8 You found his heart faithful to you, and you made a covenant with him to give to his descendants the land of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Perizzites, Jebusites and Girgashites. You have kept your promise because you are righteous.
- 9 You saw the anguish of our parents in Egypt. You heard their cries at the Red Sea;
- 9 You saw the suffering of our forefathers in Egypt; you heard their cry at the Red Sea.
- 10 You amazed Pharaoh, his servants, and the people of his land with wonders and miracle-signs. You knew their bullying arrogance against your people; you made a name for yourself that lasts to this day.
- 10 You sent miraculous signs and wonders against Pharaoh, against all his officials and all the people of his land, for you knew how arrogantly the Egyptians treated them. You made a name for yourself, which remains to this day.
- 11 You split the sea before them; they crossed through and never got their feet wet; You pitched their pursuers into the deep; they sank like a rock in the storm-tossed sea.
- 11 You divided the sea before them, so that they passed through it on dry ground, but you hurled their pursuers into the depths, like a stone into mighty waters.
- 12 By day you led them with a Pillar of Cloud, and by night with a Pillar of Fire To show them the way they were to travel.
- 12 By day you led them with a pillar of cloud, and by night with a pillar of fire to give them light on the way they were to take.
- 13 You came down onto Mount Sinai, you spoke to them out of heaven; You gave them instructions on how to live well, true teaching, sound rules and commands;
- 13 You came down on Mount Sinai; you spoke to them from heaven. You gave them regulations and laws that are just and right, and decrees and commands that are good.
- 14 You introduced them to your Holy Sabbath; Through your servant Moses you decreed commands, rules, and instruction.
- 14 You made known to them your holy Sabbath and gave them commands, decrees and laws through your servant Moses.

- 15 You gave bread from heaven for their hunger, you sent water from the rock for their thirst. You told them to enter and take the land, which you promised to give them.
- 15 In their hunger you gave them bread from heaven and in their thirst you brought them water from the rock; you told them to go in and take possession of the land you had sworn with uplifted hand to give them.
- 16 But they, our ancestors, were arrogant; bullheaded, they wouldn't obey your commands.
- 16 But they, our forefathers, became arrogant and stiff-necked, and did not obey your commands.
- 17 They turned a deaf ear, they refused to remember the miracles you had done for them; They turned stubborn, got it into their heads to return to their Egyptian slavery. And you, a forgiving God, gracious and compassionate, Incredibly patient, with tons of love-- you didn't dump them.
- 17 They refused to listen and failed to remember the miracles you performed among them. They became stiff-necked and in their rebellion appointed a leader in order to return to their slavery. But you are a forgiving God, gracious and compassionate, slow to anger and abounding in love. Therefore you did not desert them,
- 18 Yes, even when they cast a sculpted calf and said, "This is your god Who brought you out of Egypt," and continued from bad to worse,
- 18 even when they cast for themselves an image of a calf and said, 'This is your god, who brought you up out of Egypt,' or when they committed awful blasphemies.
- 19 You in your amazing compassion didn't walk off and leave them in the desert. The Pillar of Cloud didn't leave them; daily it continued to show them their route; The Pillar of Fire did the same by night, showed them the right way to go.
- 19 Because of your great compassion you did not abandon them in the desert. By day the pillar of cloud did not cease to guide them on their path, nor the pillar of fire by night to shine on the way they were to take.
- 20 You gave them your good Spirit to teach them to live wisely. You never stinted with your manna, gave them plenty of water to drink.
- 20 You gave your good Spirit to instruct them. You did not withhold your manna from their mouths, and you gave them water for their thirst.

- 21 You supported them forty years in that desert; they had everything they needed; Their clothes didn't wear out and their feet never blistered.
- 21 For forty years you sustained them in the desert; they lacked nothing, their clothes did not wear out nor did their feet become swollen.
- 22 You gave them kingdoms and peoples, establishing generous boundaries. They took over the country of Sihon king of Heshbon and the country of Og king of Bashan.
- 22 You gave them kingdoms and nations, allotting to them even the remotest frontiers. They took over the country of Sihon king of Heshbon and the country of Og king of Bashan.
- 23 You multiplied children for them, rivaling the stars in the night skies, And you brought them into the land that you promised their ancestors they would get and own.
- 23 You made their sons as numerous as the stars in the sky, and you brought them into the land that you told their fathers to enter and possess.
- 24 Well, they entered all right, they took it and settled in. The Canaanites who lived there you brought to their knees before them. You turned over their land, kings, and peoples to do with as they pleased.
- 24 Their sons went in and took possession of the land. You subdued before them the Canaanites, who lived in the land; you handed the Canaanites over to them, along with their kings and the peoples of the land, to deal with them as they pleased.
- 25 They took strong cities and fertile fields, they took over well-furnished houses, Cisterns, vineyards, olive groves, and lush, extensive orchards. And they ate, grew fat on the fat of the land; they reveled in your bountiful goodness.
- 25 They captured fortified cities and fertile land; they took possession of houses filled with all kinds of good things, wells already dug, vineyards, olive groves and fruit trees in abundance. They ate to the full and were well-nourished; they reveled in your great goodness.
- 26 But then they mutinied, rebelled against you, threw out your laws and killed your prophets, The very prophets who tried to get them back on your side-- and then things went from bad to worse.
- 26 But they were disobedient and rebelled against you; they put your law behind their backs. They killed your prophets, who had admonished

them in order to turn them back to you; they committed awful blasphemies.

27 You turned them over to their enemies, who made life rough for them. But when they called out for help in their troubles you listened from heaven; And in keeping with your bottomless compassion you gave them saviors: Saviors who saved them from the cruel abuse of their enemies.

27 So you handed them over to their enemies, who oppressed them. But when they were oppressed they cried out to you. From heaven you heard them, and in your great compassion you gave them deliverers, who rescued them from the hand of their enemies.

28 But as soon as they had it easy again they were right back at it--more evil. So you turned away and left them again to their fate, to the enemies who came right back. They cried out to you again; in your great compassion you heard and helped them again. This went on over and over and over.

28 But as soon as they were at rest, they again did what was evil in your sight. Then you abandoned them to the hand of their enemies so that they ruled over them. And when they cried out to you again, you heard from heaven, and in your compassion you delivered them time after time.

29 You warned them to return to your Revelation, they responded with haughty arrogance: They flouted your commands, spurned your rules -- the very words by which men and women live! They set their jaws in defiance, they turned their backs on you and didn't listen.

29 You warned them to return to your law, but they became arrogant and disobeyed your commands. They sinned against your ordinances, by which a man will live if he obeys them. Stubbornly they turned their backs on you, became stiff-necked and refused to listen.

30 You put up with them year after year and warned them by your spirit through your prophets; But when they refused to listen you abandoned them to foreigners.

30 For many years you were patient with them. By your Spirit you admonished them through your prophets. Yet they paid no attention, so you handed them over to the neighboring peoples.

31 Still, because of your great compassion, you didn't make a total end to them. You didn't walk out and leave them for good; yes, you are a God of grace and compassion.

- 31 But in your great mercy you did not put an end to them or abandon them, for you are a gracious and merciful God.
- 32 And now, our God, the great God, God majestic and terrible, loyal in covenant and love, Don't treat lightly the trouble that has come to us, to our kings and princes, our priests and prophets, Our ancestors, and all your people from the time of the Assyrian kings right down to today.
- 32 Now therefore, O our God, the great, mighty and awesome God, who keeps his covenant of love, do not let all this hardship seem trifling in your eyes--the hardship that has come upon us, upon our kings and leaders, upon our priests and prophets, upon our fathers and all your people, from the days of the kings of Assyria until today.
- 33 You are not to blame for all that has come down on us; You did everything right, we did everything wrong.
- 33 In all that has happened to us, you have been just; you have acted faithfully, while we did wrong.
- 34 None of our kings, princes, priests, or ancestors followed your Revelation; They ignored your commands, dismissed the warnings you gave them.
- 34 Our kings, our leaders, our priests and our fathers did not follow your law; they did not pay attention to your commands or the warnings you gave them.
- 35 Even when they had their own kingdom and were enjoying your generous goodness, Living in that spacious and fertile land that you spread out before them, They didn't serve you or turn their backs on the practice of evil.
- 35 Even while they were in their kingdom, enjoying your great goodness to them in the spacious and fertile land you gave them, they did not serve you or turn from their evil ways.
- 36 And here we are, slaves again today; and here's the land you gave our ancestors So they could eat well and enjoy a good life, and now look at us--no better than slaves on this land.
- 36 But see, we are slaves today, slaves in the land you gave our forefathers so they could eat its fruit and the other good things it produces.
- 37 Its wonderful crops go to the kings you put over us because of our sins; They act like they own our bodies and do whatever they like with our cattle. We're in deep trouble.

- 37 Because of our sins, its abundant harvest goes to the kings you have placed over us. They rule over our bodies and our cattle as they please. We are in great distress.
- 38 "Because of all this we are drawing up a binding pledge, a sealed document signed by our princes, our Levites, and our priests."
- 38 In view of all this, we are making a binding agreement, putting it in writing, and our leaders, our Levites and our priests are affixing their seals to it.

Nehemiah 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 The sealed document bore these signatures: Nehemiah the governor, son of Hacaliah, Zedekiah,
- 1 Those who sealed it were: Nehemiah the governor, the son of Hacaliah. Zedekiah,
- 2 Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah,
- 2 Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah,
- 3 Pashhur, Amariah, Malkijah,
- 3 Pashhur, Amariah, Malkijah,
- 4 Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch,
- 4 Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch,
- 5 Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah,
- 5 Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah,
- 6 Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,
- 6 Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,
- 7 Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin,
- 7 Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin,
- 8 Maaziah, Bilgai, and Shemaiah. These were the priests.
- 8 Maaziah, Bilgai and Shemaiah. These were the priests.
- 9 The Levites: Jeshua son of Azaniah, Binnui of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel,
- 9 The Levites: Jeshua son of Azaniah, Binnui of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel,
- 10 and their kinsmen: Shebaniah, Hodiah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan,

10 and their associates: Shebaniah, Hodiah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan,
11 Mica, Rehob, Hashabiah,
11 Mica, Rehob, Hashabiah,
12 Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah,
12 Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah,
13 Hodiah, Bani, and Beninu.
13 Hodiah, Bani and Beninu.
14 The heads of the people: Parosh, Pahath-Moab, Elam, Zattu, Bani,
14 The leaders of the people: Parosh, Pahath-Moab, Elam, Zattu, Bani,
15 Bunni, Azgad, Bebai,
15 Bunni, Azgad, Bebai,
16 Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,
16 Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,
17 Ater, Hezekiah, Azzur,
17 Ater, Hezekiah, Azzur,
18 Hodiah, Hashum, Bezai,
18 Hodiah, Hashum, Bezai,
19 Hariph, Anathoth, Nebai,
19 Hariph, Anathoth, Nebai,
20 Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir,
20 Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir,
21 Meshezabel, Zadok, Jaddua,
21 Meshezabel, Zadok, Jaddua,
22 Pelatiah, Hanan, Anaiah,
22 Pelatiah, Hanan, Anaiah,
23 Hoshea, Hananiah, Hasshub,
23 Hoshea, Hananiah, Hasshub,
24 Hallohesh, Pilha, Shobek,
24 Hallohesh, Pilha, Shobek,
25 Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,
25 Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,
26 Ahiah, Hanan, Anan,
26 Ahiah, Hanan, Anan,
27 Malluch, Harim, and Baanah.
27 Malluch, Harim and Baanah.

- 28 The rest of the people, priests, Levites, security guards, singers, Temple staff, and all who separated themselves from the foreign neighbors to keep The Revelation of God, together with their wives, sons, daughters--everyone old enough to understand--
- 28 The rest of the people--priests, Levites, gatekeepers, singers, temple servants and all who separated themselves from the neighboring peoples for the sake of the Law of God, together with their wives and all their sons and daughters who are able to understand--
- 29 all joined their noble kinsmen in a binding oath to follow The Revelation of God given through Moses the servant of God, to keep and carry out all the commandments of GOD our Master, all his decisions and standards.
- 29 all these now join their brothers the nobles, and bind themselves with a curse and an oath to follow the Law of God given through Moses the servant of God and to obey carefully all the commands, regulations and decrees of the LORD our Lord.
- 30 Thus: We will not marry our daughters to our foreign neighbors nor let our sons marry their daughters.
- 30 We promise not to give our daughters in marriage to the peoples around us or take their daughters for our sons.
- 31 When the foreign neighbors bring goods or grain to sell on the Sabbath we won't trade with them--not on the Sabbath or any other holy day. Every seventh year we will leave the land fallow and cancel all debts.
- 31 When the neighboring peoples bring merchandise or grain to sell on the Sabbath, we will not buy from them on the Sabbath or on any holy day. Every seventh year we will forgo working the land and will cancel all debts.
- 32 We accept the responsibility for paying an annual tax of one-third of a shekel (about an eighth ounce) for providing The Temple of our God with
- 32 We assume the responsibility for carrying out the commands to give a third of a shekel each year for the service of the house of our God:
- 33 bread for the Table regular Grain-Offerings regular Whole-Burnt-Offerings offerings for the Sabbaths, New Moons, and appointed feasts, Dedication-Offerings, Absolution-Offerings to atone for Israel maintenance of The Temple of our God.

- 33 for the bread set out on the table; for the regular grain offerings and burnt offerings; for the offerings on the Sabbaths, New Moon festivals and appointed feasts; for the holy offerings; for sin offerings to make atonement for Israel; and for all the duties of the house of our God.
- 34 We--priests, Levites, and the people--have cast lots to see when each of our families will bring wood for burning on the Altar of our GOD, following the yearly schedule set down in The Revelation.
- 34 We--the priests, the Levites and the people--have cast lots to determine when each of our families is to bring to the house of our God at set times each year a contribution of wood to burn on the altar of the LORD our God, as it is written in the Law.
- 35 We take responsibility for delivering annually to The Temple of GOD the firstfruits of our crops and our orchards,
- 35 We also assume responsibility for bringing to the house of the LORD each year the firstfruits of our crops and of every fruit tree.
- 36 our firstborn sons and cattle, and the firstborn from our herds and flocks for the priests who serve in The Temple of our God--just as it is set down in The Revelation.
- 36 As it is also written in the Law, we will bring the firstborn of our sons and of our cattle, of our herds and of our flocks to the house of our God, to the priests ministering there.
- 37 We will bring the best of our grain, of our contributions, of the fruit of every tree, of wine, and of oil to the priests in the storerooms of The Temple of our God. We will bring the tithes from our fields to the Levites, since the Levites are appointed to collect the tithes in the towns where we work.
- 37 Moreover, we will bring to the storerooms of the house of our God, to the priests, the first of our ground meal, of our grain offerings, of the fruit of all our trees and of our new wine and oil. And we will bring a tithe of our crops to the Levites, for it is the Levites who collect the tithes in all the towns where we work.
- 38 We'll see to it that a priest descended from Aaron will supervise the Levites as they collect the tithes and make sure that they take a tenth of the tithes to the treasury in The Temple of our God.

- 38 A priest descended from Aaron is to accompany the Levites when they receive the tithes, and the Levites are to bring a tenth of the tithes up to the house of our God, to the storerooms of the treasury.
- 39 We'll see to it that the People of Israel and Levites bring the grain, wine, and oil to the storage rooms where the vessels of the Sanctuary are kept and where the priests who serve, the security guards, and the choir meet. We will not neglect The Temple of our God.
- 39 The people of Israel, including the Levites, are to bring their contributions of grain, new wine and oil to the storerooms where the articles for the sanctuary are kept and where the ministering priests, the gatekeepers and the singers stay. "We will not neglect the house of our God."

Nehemiah 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 The leaders of the people were already living in Jerusalem, so the rest of the people drew lots to get one out of ten to move to Jerusalem, the holy city, while the other nine remained in their towns.
- 1 Now the leaders of the people settled in Jerusalem, and the rest of the people cast lots to bring one out of every ten to live in Jerusalem, the holy city, while the remaining nine were to stay in their own towns.
- 2 The people applauded those who voluntarily offered to live in Jerusalem.
- 2 The people commended all the men who volunteered to live in Jerusalem.
- 3 These are the leaders in the province who resided in Jerusalem (some Israelites, priests, Levites, Temple staff, and descendants of Solomon's slaves lived in the towns of Judah on their own property in various towns;
- 3 These are the provincial leaders who settled in Jerusalem (now some Israelites, priests, Levites, temple servants and descendants of Solomon's servants lived in the towns of Judah, each on his own property in the various towns,
- 4 others from both Judah and Benjamin lived in Jerusalem): From the family of Judah: Athaiah son of Uziah, the son of Zechariah, the son of

- Amariah, the son of Shephatiah, the son of Mahalalel, from the family line of Perez;
- 4 while other people from both Judah and Benjamin lived in Jerusalem): From the descendants of Judah: Athaiah son of Uzziah, the son of Zechariah, the son of Amariah, the son of Shephatiah, the son of Mahalalel, a descendant of Perez;
 - 5 Maaseiah son of Baruch, the son of Col-Hozeh, the son of Hazaiah, the son of Adaiah, the son of Joiarib, the son of Zechariah, the son of the Shilonite.
 - 5 and Maaseiah son of Baruch, the son of Col-Hozeh, the son of Hazaiah, the son of Adaiah, the son of Joiarib, the son of Zechariah, a descendant of Shelah.
 - 6 The descendants of Perez who lived in Jerusalem numbered 468 valiant men.
 - 6 The descendants of Perez who lived in Jerusalem totaled 468 able men.
 - 7 From the family of Benjamin: Sallu son of Meshullam, the son of Joed, the son of Pedaiah, the son of Kolaiah, the son of Maaseiah, the son of Ithiel, the son of Jeshaiiah,
 - 7 From the descendants of Benjamin: Sallu son of Meshullam, the son of Joed, the son of Pedaiah, the son of Kolaiah, the son of Maaseiah, the son of Ithiel, the son of Jeshaiiah,
 - 8 and his brothers Gabbai and Sallai: 928 men.
 - 8 and his followers, Gabbai and Sallai--928 men.
 - 9 Joel son of Zicri was their chief and Judah son of Hassenuah was second in command over the city.
 - 9 Joel son of Zicri was their chief officer, and Judah son of Hassenuah was over the Second District of the city.
 - 10 From the priests: Jedaiah son of Joiarib; Jakin;
 - 10 From the priests: Jedaiah; the son of Joiarib; Jakin;
 - 11 Seraiah son of Hilkiyah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, supervisor of The Temple of God,
 - 11 Seraiah son of Hilkiyah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, supervisor in the house of God,
 - 12 along with their associates responsible for work in The Temple: 822 men. Also Adaiah son of Jeroham, the son of Pelaliah, the son of Amzi, the son of Zechariah, the son of Pashhur, the son of Malkijah,

- 12 and their associates, who carried on work for the temple--822 men; Adaiah son of Jeroham, the son of Pelaliah, the son of Amzi, the son of Zechariah, the son of Pashhur, the son of Malkijah,
- 13 and his associates who were heads of families: 242 men; Amashsai son of Azarel, the son of Ahzai, the son of Meshillemoth, the son of Immer,
- 13 and his associates, who were heads of families--242 men; Amashsai son of Azarel, the son of Ahzai, the son of Meshillemoth, the son of Immer,
- 14 and his associates, all valiant men: 128 men. Their commander was Zabdiel son of Haggedolim.
- 14 and his associates, who were able men--128. Their chief officer was Zabdiel son of Haggedolim.
- 15 From the Levites: Shemaiah son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Bunni;
- 15 From the Levites: Shemaiah son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Bunni;
- 16 Shabbethai and Jozabad, two of the leaders of the Levites who were in charge of the outside work of The Temple of God;
- 16 Shabbethai and Jozabad, two of the heads of the Levites, who had charge of the outside work of the house of God;
- 17 Mattaniah son of Mica, the son of Zabdi, the son of Asaph, the director who led in thanksgiving and prayer; Bakbukiah, second among his associates; and Abda son of Shammua, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun.
- 17 Mattaniah son of Mica, the son of Zabdi, the son of Asaph, the director who led in thanksgiving and prayer; Bakbukiah, second among his associates; and Abda son of Shammua, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun.
- 18 The Levites in the holy city totaled 284.
- 18 The Levites in the holy city totaled 284.
- 19 From the security guards: Akkub, Talmon, and their associates who kept watch over the gates: 172 men.
- 19 The gatekeepers: Akkub, Talmon and their associates, who kept watch at the gates--172 men.
- 20 The rest of the Israelites, priests, and Levites were in all the towns of Judah, each on his own family property.

- 20 The rest of the Israelites, with the priests and Levites, were in all the towns of Judah, each on his ancestral property.
- 21 The Temple staff lived on the hill Ophel. Ziha and Gishpa were responsible for them.
- 21 The temple servants lived on the hill of Ophel, and Ziha and Gishpa were in charge of them.
- 22 The chief officer over the Levites in Jerusalem was Uzzi son of Bani, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Mica. Uzzi was one of Asaph's descendants, singers who led worship in The Temple of God.
- 22 The chief officer of the Levites in Jerusalem was Uzzi son of Bani, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Mica. Uzzi was one of Asaph's descendants, who were the singers responsible for the service of the house of God.
- 23 The singers got their orders from the king, who drew up their daily schedule.
- 23 The singers were under the king's orders, which regulated their daily activity.
- 24 Pethahiah son of Meshezabel, a descendant of Zerah son of Judah, represented the people's concerns at the royal court.
- 24 Pethahiah son of Meshezabel, one of the descendants of Zerah son of Judah, was the king's agent in all affairs relating to the people.
- 25 Some of the Judeans lived in the villages near their farms: Kiriath Arba (Hebron) and suburbs, Dibon and suburbs, Jekabzeel and suburbs
- 25 As for the villages with their fields, some of the people of Judah lived in Kiriath Arba and its surrounding settlements, in Dibon and its settlements, in Jekabzeel and its villages,
- 26 Jeshua, Moladah, Beth Pelet
- 26 in Jeshua, in Moladah, in Beth Pelet,
- 27 Hazar Shual, Beersheba and suburbs
- 27 in Hazar Shual, in Beersheba and its settlements,
- 28 Ziklag, Meconah and suburbs
- 28 in Ziklag, in Meconah and its settlements,
- 29 En Rimmon, Zorah, Jarmuth
- 29 in En Rimmon, in Zorah, in Jarmuth,

- 30 Zanoah, Adullam and their towns, Lachish and its fields, Azekah and suburbs. They were living all the way from Beersheba to the Valley of Hinnom.
- 30 Zanoah, Adullam and their villages, in Lachish and its fields, and in Azekah and its settlements. So they were living all the way from Beersheba to the Valley of Hinnom.
- 31 The Benjaminites from Geba lived in: Micmash, Aijah, Bethel and its suburbs
- 31 The descendants of the Benjamites from Geba lived in Micmash, Aija, Bethel and its settlements,
- 32 Anathoth, Nob and Ananiah
- 32 in Anathoth, Nob and Ananiah,
- 33 Hazor, Ramah and Gittaim
- 33 in Hazor, Ramah and Gittaim,
- 34 Hadid, Zeboim, and Neballat
- 34 in Hadid, Zeboim and Neballat,
- 35 Lod and Ono and the Valley of the Craftsmen.
- 35 in Lod and Ono, and in the Valley of the Craftsmen.
- 36 Also some of the Levitical groups of Judah were assigned to Benjamin.
- 36 Some of the divisions of the Levites of Judah settled in Benjamin.

Nehemiah 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the priests and Levites who came up with Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel and with Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra,
- 1 These were the priests and Levites who returned with Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel and with Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra,
- 2 Amariah, Malluch, Hattush,
- 2 Amariah, Malluch, Hattush,
- 3 Shecaniah, Rehum, Meremoth,
- 3 Shecaniah, Rehum, Meremoth,
- 4 Iddo, Ginnethon, Abijah,
- 4 Iddo, Ginnethon, Abijah,
- 5 Mijamin, Moadiah, Bilgah,

5 Mijamin, Moadiah, Bilgah,
6 Shemaiah, Joiarib, Jedaiah,
6 Shemaiah, Joiarib, Jedaiah,
7 Sallu, Amok, Hilkihah, and Jedaiah. These were the leaders of the priests during the time of Jeshua.
7 Sallu, Amok, Hilkihah and Jedaiah. These were the leaders of the priests and their associates in the days of Jeshua.
8 And the Levites: Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah; Mattaniah, with his brothers, was in charge of songs of praise,
8 The Levites were Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah, and also Mattaniah, who, together with his associates, was in charge of the songs of thanksgiving.
9 and their brothers Bakbukiah and Unni stood opposite them in the services of worship.
9 Bakbukiah and Unni, their associates, stood opposite them in the services.
10 Jeshua fathered Joiakim, Joiakim fathered Eliashib, Eliashib fathered Joiada,
10 Jeshua was the father of Joiakim, Joiakim the father of Eliashib, Eliashib the father of Joiada,
11 Joiada fathered Jonathan, and Jonathan fathered Jaddua.
11 Joiada the father of Jonathan, and Jonathan the father of Jaddua.
12 During the time of Joiakim, these were the heads of the priestly families: of the family of Seraiah, Meraiah; of Jeremiah, Hananiah;
12 In the days of Joiakim, these were the heads of the priestly families: of Seraiah's family, Meraiah; of Jeremiah's, Hananiah;
13 of Ezra, Meshullam; of Amariah, Jehohanan;
13 of Ezra's, Meshullam; of Amariah's, Jehohanan;
14 of Malluch, Jonathan; of Shecaniah, Joseph;
14 of Malluch's, Jonathan; of Shecaniah's, Joseph;
15 of Harim, Adna; of Meremoth, Helkai;
15 of Harim's, Adna; of Meremoth's, Helkai;
16 of Iddo, Zechariah; of Ginnethon, Meshullam;
16 of Iddo's, Zechariah; of Ginnethon's, Meshullam;
17 of Abijah, Zicri; of Miniamin and Moadiah, Piltai;
17 of Abijah's, Zicri; of Miniamin's and of Moadiah's, Piltai;

- 18 of Bilgah, Shammua; of Shemaiah, Jehonathan;
18 of Bilgah's, Shammua; of Shemaiah's, Jehonathan;
19 of Joiarib, Mattenai; of Jedaiah, Uzzi;
19 of Joiarib's, Mattenai; of Jedaiah's, Uzzi;
20 of Sallu, Kallai; of Amok, Eber;
20 of Sallu's, Kallai; of Amok's, Eber;
21 of Hilkiah, Hashabiah; and of Jedaiah, Nethanel.
21 of Hilkiah's, Hashabiah; of Jedaiah's, Nethanel.
22 During the time of Eliashib, Joiada, Johanan, and Jaddua, the Levites were registered as heads of families. During the reign of Darius the Persian, the priests were registered.
22 The family heads of the Levites in the days of Eliashib, Joiada, Johanan and Jaddua, as well as those of the priests, were recorded in the reign of Darius the Persian.
23 The Levites who were heads of families were registered in the Book of the Chronicles until the time of Johanan son of Eliashib. These were:
23 The family heads among the descendants of Levi up to the time of Johanan son of Eliashib were recorded in the book of the annals.
24 Hashabiah, Sherebiah, and Jeshua son of Kadmiel. Their brothers stood opposite them to give praise and thanksgiving, one side responding to the other, as had been directed by David the man of God.
24 And the leaders of the Levites were Hashabiah, Sherebiah, Jeshua son of Kadmiel, and their associates, who stood opposite them to give praise and thanksgiving, one section responding to the other, as prescribed by David the man of God.
25 The security guards included: Mattaniah, Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, and Akkub. They guarded the storerooms at the gates.
25 Mattaniah, Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon and Akkub were gatekeepers who guarded the storerooms at the gates.
26 They lived during the time of Joiakim son of Jeshua, the son of Jozadak, the time of Nehemiah the governor and of Ezra the priest and scholar.
26 They served in the days of Joiakim son of Jeshua, the son of Jozadak, and in the days of Nehemiah the governor and of Ezra the priest and scribe.

- 27 When it came time for the dedication of the wall, they tracked down and brought in the Levites from all their homes in Jerusalem to carry out the dedication exuberantly: thanksgiving hymns, songs, cymbals, harps, and lutes.
- 27 At the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem, the Levites were sought out from where they lived and were brought to Jerusalem to celebrate joyfully the dedication with songs of thanksgiving and with the music of cymbals, harps and lyres.
- 28 The singers assembled from all around Jerusalem, from the villages of the Netophathites,
- 28 The singers also were brought together from the region around Jerusalem--from the villages of the Netophathites,
- 29 from Beth Gilgal, from the farms at Geba and Azmaveth--the singers had built villages for themselves all around Jerusalem.
- 29 from Beth Gilgal, and from the area of Geba and Azmaveth, for the singers had built villages for themselves around Jerusalem.
- 30 The priests and Levites ceremonially purified themselves; then they did the same for the people, the gates, and the wall.
- 30 When the priests and Levites had purified themselves ceremonially, they purified the people, the gates and the wall.
- 31 I had the leaders of Judah come up on the wall, and I appointed two large choirs. One proceeded on the wall to the right toward the Dung Gate.
- 31 I had the leaders of Judah go up on top of the wall. I also assigned two large choirs to give thanks. One was to proceed on top of the wall to the right, toward the Dung Gate.
- 32 Hashaiah and half the leaders of Judah followed them,
- 32 Hoshaiiah and half the leaders of Judah followed them,
- 33 including Azariah, Ezra, Meshullam,
- 33 along with Azariah, Ezra, Meshullam,
- 34 Judah, Benjamin, Shemaiah, and Jeremiah.
- 34 Judah, Benjamin, Shemaiah, Jeremiah,
- 35 Some of the young priests had trumpets. Next, playing the musical instruments of David the man of God, came Zechariah son of Jonathan, the son of Shemaiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Micaiah, the son of Zaccur, the son of Asaph,

35 as well as some priests with trumpets, and also Zechariah son of Jonathan, the son of Shemaiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Micaiah, the son of Zaccur, the son of Asaph,

36 and his brothers Shemaiah, Azarel, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethanel, Judah, and Hanani. Ezra the scholar led them.

36 and his associates--Shemaiah, Azarel, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethanel, Judah and Hanani--with musical instruments prescribed by David the man of God. Ezra the scribe led the procession.

37 At the Fountain Gate they went straight ahead, up the steps of the City of David using the wall stairway above the house of David to the Water Gate on the east.

37 At the Fountain Gate they continued directly up the steps of the City of David on the ascent to the wall and passed above the house of David to the Water Gate on the east.

38 The other choir proceeded to the left. I and half of the people followed them on the wall from the Tower of Furnaces to the Broad Wall,

38 The second choir proceeded in the opposite direction. I followed them on top of the wall, together with half the people--past the Tower of the Ovens to the Broad Wall,

39 over the Ephraim Gate, the Jeshanah Gate, the Fish Gate, the Tower of Hananel, and the Tower of the Hundred as far as the Sheep Gate, stopping at the Prison Gate.

39 over the Gate of Ephraim, the Jeshanah Gate, the Fish Gate, the Tower of Hananel and the Tower of the Hundred, as far as the Sheep Gate. At the Gate of the Guard they stopped.

40 The two choirs then took their places in The Temple of God. I was there with half of the officials,

40 The two choirs that gave thanks then took their places in the house of God; so did I, together with half the officials,

41 along with the priests Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Micaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah with their trumpets.

41 as well as the priests--Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Micaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah and Hananiah with their trumpets--

42 Also Maaseiah, Shemaiah, Eleazar, Uzzi, Jehohanan, Malkijah, Elam, and Ezer. The singers, directed by Jezrahiah, made the rafters ring.

- 42 and also Maaseiah, Shemaiah, Eleazar, Uzzi, Jehohanan, Malkijah, Elam and Ezer. The choirs sang under the direction of Jezrahiah.
- 43 That day they offered great sacrifices, an exuberant celebration because God had filled them with great joy. The women and children raised their happy voices with all the rest. Jerusalem's jubilation was heard far and wide.
- 43 And on that day they offered great sacrifices, rejoicing because God had given them great joy. The women and children also rejoiced. The sound of rejoicing in Jerusalem could be heard far away.
- 44 That same day men were appointed to be responsible for the storerooms for the offerings, the firstfruits, and the tithes. They saw to it that the portion directed by The Revelation for the priests and Levites was brought in from the farms connected to the towns. Judah was so appreciative of the priests and Levites and their service;
- 44 At that time men were appointed to be in charge of the storerooms for the contributions, firstfruits and tithes. From the fields around the towns they were to bring into the storerooms the portions required by the Law for the priests and the Levites, for Judah was pleased with the ministering priests and Levites.
- 45 they, along with the singers and security guards, had done everything so well, conducted the worship of their God and the ritual of ceremonial cleansing in a way that would have made David and his son Solomon proud.
- 45 They performed the service of their God and the service of purification, as did also the singers and gatekeepers, according to the commands of David and his son Solomon.
- 46 That's the way it was done in the olden days, the days of David and Asaph, when they had choir directors for singing songs of praise and thanksgiving to God.
- 46 For long ago, in the days of David and Asaph, there had been directors for the singers and for the songs of praise and thanksgiving to God.
- 47 During the time of Zerubbabel and Nehemiah, all Israel contributed the daily allowances for the singers and security guards. They also set aside what was dedicated to the Levites, and the Levites did the same for the Aaronites.

47 So in the days of Zerubbabel and of Nehemiah, all Israel contributed the daily portions for the singers and gatekeepers. They also set aside the portion for the other Levites, and the Levites set aside the portion for the descendants of Aaron.

Nehemiah 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 Also on that same day there was a reading from the Book of Moses in the hearing of the people. It was found written there that no Ammonite or Moabite was permitted to enter the congregation of God,
- 1 On that day the Book of Moses was read aloud in the hearing of the people and there it was found written that no Ammonite or Moabite should ever be admitted into the assembly of God,
- 2 because they hadn't welcomed the People of Israel with food and drink; they even hired Balaam to work against them by cursing them, but our God turned the curse into a blessing.
- 2 because they had not met the Israelites with food and water but had hired Balaam to call a curse down on them. (Our God, however, turned the curse into a blessing.)
- 3 When they heard the reading of The Revelation, they excluded all foreigners from Israel.
- 3 When the people heard this law, they excluded from Israel all who were of foreign descent.
- 4 Some time before this, Eliashib the priest had been put in charge of the storerooms of The Temple of God. He was close to Tobiah
- 4 Before this, Eliashib the priest had been put in charge of the storerooms of the house of our God. He was closely associated with Tobiah,
- 5 and had made available to him a large storeroom that had been used to store Grain-Offerings, incense, worship vessels, and the tithes of grain, wine, and oil for the Levites, singers, and security guards, and the offerings for the priests.
- 5 and he had provided him with a large room formerly used to store the grain offerings and incense and temple articles, and also the tithes of

- grain, new wine and oil prescribed for the Levites, singers and gatekeepers, as well as the contributions for the priests.
- 6 When this was going on I wasn't there in Jerusalem; in the thirty-second year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon, I had traveled back to the king. But later I asked for his permission to leave again.
- 6 But while all this was going on, I was not in Jerusalem, for in the thirty-second year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon I had returned to the king. Some time later I asked his permission
- 7 I arrived in Jerusalem and learned of the wrong that Eliashib had done in turning over to him a room in the courts of The Temple of God.
- 7 and came back to Jerusalem. Here I learned about the evil thing Eliashib had done in providing Tobiah a room in the courts of the house of God.
- 8 I was angry, really angry, and threw everything in the room out into the street, all of Tobiah's stuff.
- 8 I was greatly displeased and threw all Tobiah's household goods out of the room.
- 9 Then I ordered that they ceremonially cleanse the room. Only then did I put back the worship vessels of The Temple of God, along with the Grain-Offerings and the incense.
- 9 I gave orders to purify the rooms, and then I put back into them the equipment of the house of God, with the grain offerings and the incense.
- 10 And then I learned that the Levites hadn't been given their regular food allotments. So the Levites and singers who led the services of worship had all left and gone back to their farms.
- 10 I also learned that the portions assigned to the Levites had not been given to them, and that all the Levites and singers responsible for the service had gone back to their own fields.
- 11 I called the officials on the carpet, "Why has The Temple of God been abandoned?" I got everyone back again and put them back on their jobs
- 11 So I rebuked the officials and asked them, "Why is the house of God neglected?" Then I called them together and stationed them at their posts.
- 12 so that all Judah was again bringing in the tithe of grain, wine, and oil to the storerooms.
- 12 All Judah brought the tithes of grain, new wine and oil into the storerooms.

- 13 I put Shelemiah the priest, Zadok the scribe, and a Levite named Pedaiah in charge of the storerooms. I made Hanan son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah, their right-hand man. These men had a reputation for honesty and hard work. They were responsible for distributing the rations to their brothers.
- 13 I put Shelemiah the priest, Zadok the scribe, and a Levite named Pedaiah in charge of the storerooms and made Hanan son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah, their assistant, because these men were considered trustworthy. They were made responsible for distributing the supplies to their brothers.
- 14 Remember me, O my God, for this. Don't ever forget the devoted work I have done for The Temple of God and its worship.
- 14 Remember me for this, O my God, and do not blot out what I have so faithfully done for the house of my God and its services.
- 15 During those days, while back in Judah, I also noticed that people treaded wine presses, brought in sacks of grain, and loaded up their donkeys on the Sabbath. They brought wine, grapes, figs, and all kinds of stuff to sell on the Sabbath. So I spoke up and warned them about selling food on that day.
- 15 In those days I saw men in Judah treading winepresses on the Sabbath and bringing in grain and loading it on donkeys, together with wine, grapes, figs and all other kinds of loads. And they were bringing all this into Jerusalem on the Sabbath. Therefore I warned them against selling food on that day.
- 16 Tyrians living there brought in fish and whatever else, selling it to Judeans--in Jerusalem, mind you!--on the Sabbath.
- 16 Men from Tyre who lived in Jerusalem were bringing in fish and all kinds of merchandise and selling them in Jerusalem on the Sabbath to the people of Judah.
- 17 I confronted the leaders of Judah: "What's going on here? This evil! Profaning the Sabbath!
- 17 I rebuked the nobles of Judah and said to them, "What is this wicked thing you are doing--desecrating the Sabbath day?
- 18 Isn't this exactly what your ancestors did? And because of it didn't God bring down on us and this city all this misery? And here you are adding to it--accumulating more wrath on Jerusalem by profaning the Sabbath."

- 18 Didn't your forefathers do the same things, so that our God brought all this calamity upon us and upon this city? Now you are stirring up more wrath against Israel by desecrating the Sabbath."
- 19 As the gates of Jerusalem were darkened by the shadows of the approaching Sabbath, I ordered the doors shut and not to be opened until the Sabbath was over. I placed some of my servants at the gates to make sure that nothing to be sold would get in on the Sabbath day.
- 19 When evening shadows fell on the gates of Jerusalem before the Sabbath, I ordered the doors to be shut and not opened until the Sabbath was over. I stationed some of my own men at the gates so that no load could be brought in on the Sabbath day.
- 20 Traders and dealers in various goods camped outside the gates once or twice.
- 20 Once or twice the merchants and sellers of all kinds of goods spent the night outside Jerusalem.
- 21 But I took them to task. I said, "You have no business camping out here by the wall. If I find you here again, I'll use force to drive you off." And that did it; they didn't come back on the Sabbath.
- 21 But I warned them and said, "Why do you spend the night by the wall? If you do this again, I will lay hands on you." From that time on they no longer came on the Sabbath.
- 22 Then I directed the Levites to ceremonially cleanse themselves and take over as guards at the gates to keep the sanctity of the Sabbath day. Remember me also for this, my God. Treat me with mercy according to your great and steadfast love.
- 22 Then I commanded the Levites to purify themselves and go and guard the gates in order to keep the Sabbath day holy. Remember me for this also, O my God, and show mercy to me according to your great love.
- 23 Also in those days I saw Jews who had married women from Ashdod, Ammon, and Moab.
- 23 Moreover, in those days I saw men of Judah who had married women from Ashdod, Ammon and Moab.
- 24 Half the children couldn't even speak the language of Judah; all they knew was the language of Ashdod or some other tongue.
- 24 Half of their children spoke the language of Ashdod or the language of one of the other peoples, and did not know how to speak the language of

Judah.

- 25 So I took those men to task, gave them a piece of my mind, even slapped some of them and jerked them by the hair. I made them swear to God: "Don't marry your daughters to their sons; and don't let their daughters marry your sons--and don't you yourselves marry them!"
- 25 I rebuked them and called curses down on them. I beat some of the men and pulled out their hair. I made them take an oath in God's name and said: "You are not to give your daughters in marriage to their sons, nor are you to take their daughters in marriage for your sons or for yourselves.
- 26 Didn't Solomon the king of Israel sin because of women just like these? Even though there was no king quite like him, and God loved him and made him king over all Israel, foreign women were his downfall.
- 26 Was it not because of marriages like these that Solomon king of Israel sinned? Among the many nations there was no king like him. He was loved by his God, and God made him king over all Israel, but even he was led into sin by foreign women.
- 27 Do you call this obedience--engaging in this extensive evil, showing yourselves faithless to God by marrying foreign wives?"
- 27 Must we hear now that you too are doing all this terrible wickedness and are being unfaithful to our God by marrying foreign women?"
- 28 One of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was a son-in-law of Sanballat the Horonite; I drove him out of my presence.
- 28 One of the sons of Joiada son of Eliashib the high priest was son-in-law to Sanballat the Horonite. And I drove him away from me.
- 29 Remember them, O my God, how they defiled the priesthood and the covenant of the priests and Levites.
- 29 Remember them, O my God, because they defiled the priestly office and the covenant of the priesthood and of the Levites.
- 30 All in all I cleansed them from everything foreign. I organized the orders of service for the priests and Levites so that each man knew his job.
- 30 So I purified the priests and the Levites of everything foreign, and assigned them duties, each to his own task.
- 31 I arranged for a regular supply of altar wood at the appointed times and for the firstfruits. Remember me, O my God, for good.

31 I also made provision for contributions of wood at designated times, and for the firstfruits. Remember me with favor, O my God.